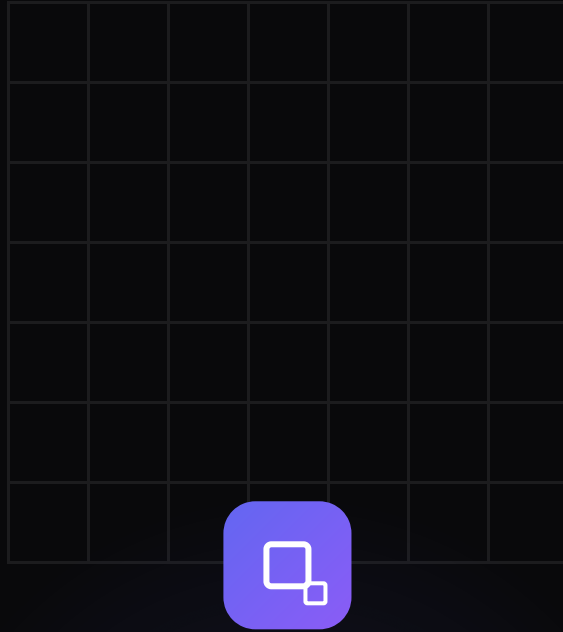




THE COMPLETE GUIDE

Design System Blueprint

A visual guide to building
consistent & scalable UI

• by [@designmotionhq](#)

Colors

Typography

Spacing

Components

Motion

What is a Design System?

A design system is a **single source of truth** — a collection of reusable components, guided by clear standards, that can be assembled to build any number of applications.

Products

Apps, websites, dashboards

Components

Buttons, cards, modals, inputs

Patterns

Layout, navigation, forms

Foundations

Colors, typography, spacing, motion

47%

Faster development

33%

Fewer inconsistencies

2×

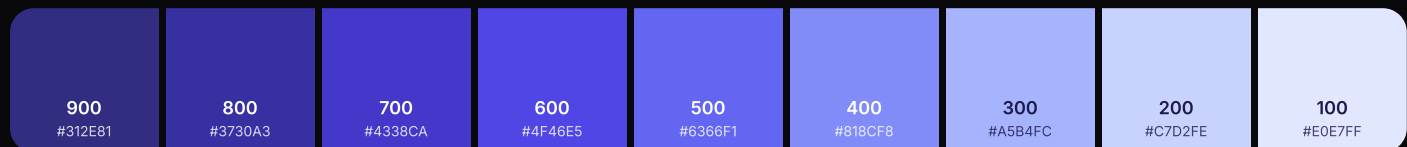
Faster onboarding

Sources: Figma Design Systems Report 2024, Brad Frost — Atomic Design

Color System

Define a semantic color palette. Don't use raw hex values — use tokens with meaningful names.

PRIMARY SCALE



SEMANTIC TOKENS

 bg.primary #09090B	 bg.surface #131316
 border.default #27272A	 text.primary #FAFAFA
 text.muted #A1A1AA	 brand.primary #6366F1
 status.success #22C55E	 status.error #EF4444



Pro tip

Always use semantic tokens (e.g. `text.primary`) instead of raw values. This makes theme switching trivial.

Typography

Scale

Use a modular scale for consistent hierarchy. Each step should feel intentional.

Aa	48px	800	text-5xl
Aa	36px	700	text-4xl
Aa	28px	700	text-3xl
Aa	22px	600	text-2xl
Aa	18px	400	text-lg
Aa	15px	400	text-base
Aa	13px	400	text-sm
Aa	11px	500	text-xs

FONT WEIGHTS

Regular 400
 Medium 500
 Semibold 600
 Bold 700
 Extrabold 800

LINE HEIGHTS

Headings: 1.1–1.3
Body: 1.5–1.7
UI Labels: 1.0–1.2

Tighter line-height for large text,
 looser for small readable text.

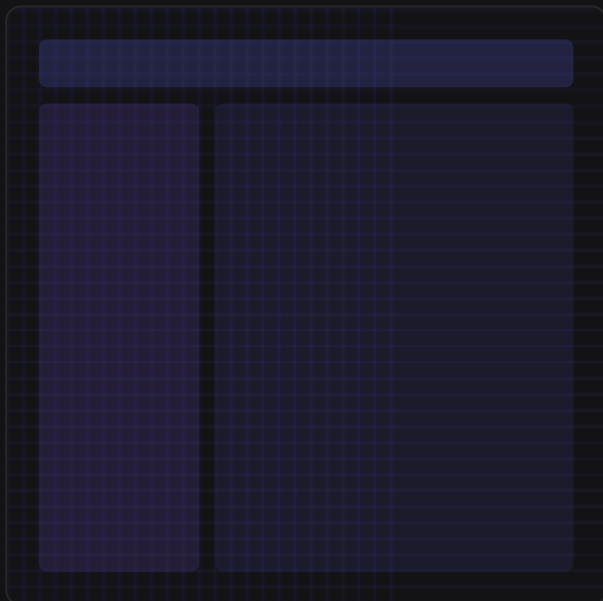
Spacing & Grid

A 4px base unit creates rhythm. Every margin, padding, and gap should be a multiple of 4.

SPACING SCALE (BASE: 4PX)

space-1	4px	
space-2	8px	
space-3	12px	
space-4	16px	
space-6	24px	
space-8	32px	
space-12	48px	
space-16	64px	

8PX GRID



COLUMN GRID (12-COL)



Columns: 12

Gutter: 16–24px

Margin: 24–48px

UI

Components

Components are the building blocks. Define every state — default, hover, active, disabled, focus.

BUTTONS

Primary**Secondary****Ghost****Destructive****Disabled****Small****Medium****Large**

INPUTS

Email

you@example.com

Name

John Doe

Disabled

Not editable

CARD

Card Title

Short description of the card content goes here.

Action

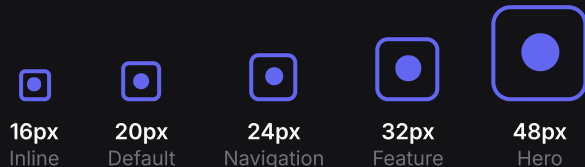
BADGES

New**Active****Pending****Error****Default**

Icons & Iconography

Icons should be consistent in style, weight, and size. Pick one library and stick with it.

ICON SIZES



STYLE RULES

- 2px stroke weight (consistent)
- Rounded caps & joins
- Optical alignment on grid
- 24×24 default bounding box
- Use `currentColor` for fills

RECOMMENDED SETS

Lucide

Clean, consistent, open-source

Phosphor

6 weights, flexible

Heroicons

By Tailwind team

Radix Icons

Minimal, 15×15 grid



Touch targets matter

Even if your icon is 20px, the interactive area should be at least **44×44px** for accessible tap targets.

Motion & Animation

Motion brings UI to life. Keep it purposeful — every animation should inform, not distract.

EASING CURVES



ease-out
Enter/appear



ease-in-out
Move/resize



ease-in
Exit/leave

DURATION SCALE

100ms		Micro — hover, toggle, fade
200ms		Small — button press, tooltip
300ms		Medium — modal, dropdown
400ms		Large — page transition, slide
500ms		XL — complex orchestration



Purposeful

Guide attention, show relationships



Fast

Never block the user. 300ms max for interactions.



Natural

Follow physics. Ease-out for enters, ease-in for exits.

Do's & Don'ts

✓ **Do: Use consistent spacing**



✗ **Don't: Eyeball spacing randomly**



✓ **Do: Limit your color palette**



✗ **Don't: Use every color you like**



✓ **Do: Use a type scale**

Heading

Body text with clear hierarchy

✗ **Don't: Use arbitrary font sizes**

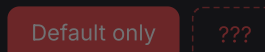
heading

body that's almost the same size

✓ **Do: Document component states**



✗ **Don't: Only design the happy path**



✓ **Do: Use semantic color tokens**

`color: var(--text-primary)`

✗ **Don't: Hardcode hex values**

`color: #1a1a2e`

Design System Checklist

Use this checklist to audit or build your design system from scratch.

FOUNDATIONS

- ☐ Define color palette (primary, neutral, semantic)
- ☐ Set up typography scale (sizes, weights, line-heights)
- ☐ Establish spacing system (4px or 8px base)
- ☐ Create grid system (columns, gutters, breakpoints)
- ☐ Choose icon library & define sizing rules

COMPONENTS

- ☐ Build atomic components (Button, Input, Badge)
- ☐ Define all states (default, hover, active, disabled, focus)
- ☐ Create composite components (Card, Modal, Dropdown)
- ☐ Document props and variants for each component
- ☐ Add responsive behavior rules

DOCUMENTATION

- ☐ Write usage guidelines for each component
- ☐ Add code examples & copy-paste snippets
- ☐ Define naming conventions (BEM, tokens)
- ☐ Create a contribution guide for the team

MOTION & POLISH

- ☐ Define easing curves & duration scale
- ☐ Add transition rules for interactive elements
- ☐ Set up dark/light theme tokens
- ☐ Create loading & empty states



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